



Paycheck Split Plan

For your Dexterity: you can't spend what never hits checking.

John says: The oldest trick in the tavern: pay yourself before the bar tab. Set it up once and it works while you sleep.

Why it works

Willpower runs out. Automation doesn't. When part of your paycheck lands in savings before you ever see it, saving stops being a decision you have to win every month.

Step by step

- ☐ Open a separate savings account (ideally at a different bank from your checking). Have the routing and account numbers handy.
- ☐ Ask HR or payroll for the direct deposit form, or find it in your payroll app. Most let you add a second account.
- ☐ Choose a fixed dollar amount or a percentage. Start at **5%** if you're unsure; you can raise it later.
- ☐ Set the savings account as the smaller deposit and checking as "remainder," so nothing bounces.
- ☐ Check the first paycheck after the change to confirm both deposits landed.

How much? Pick your level

Level	Of each paycheck	On \$2,000 take-home
Apprentice	3%	\$60
Journeyman	5%	\$100
Knight	10%	\$200
Champion	15%	\$300

Level up without feeling it

- Every raise: move half of the increase into the split.
- Every January: add one percentage point.
- Paid off a debt? Add that payment to the split for three months before you decide what else to do with it.

My plan

Account	Amount or %	Set up on	Next raise: new amount

Educational information from The Financial DM, written in plain language for adventurers of every level. It is not personalized financial, tax, or legal advice; your situation is your own, so talk it through with a professional before making big moves. Protect what matters most, because life is unpredictable. · thefinancialdm.vercel.app